
File Case #6

Case ID: 55G **Case Title:** The "Factory in Ashes" Case **Date:** November 18, 2017 **Status:** Closed

Crime Summary: A textile factory on the outskirts of the city was completely **destroyed by a fire** during the night. The owner, **Alberto Ríos**, attributed it to an electrical fault and filed a **€5 million insurance claim**.

Modus Operandi (M.O.): The fire was **intentional (arson)**. The perpetrator used a **potassium-based chemical accelerant** that burns at high temperatures and leaves very little residue, making detection difficult. The fire was started in the **meter room** to simulate a short circuit.

Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Alberto Ríos**, the factory owner.
- **Victim:** The insurance company "**Fortuna Seguros**."

Key Evidence:

- Fire department experts' report indicating **multiple points of fire origin**, inconsistent with an electrical fault.
- Financial analysis showing the factory was **on the verge of bankruptcy** and that Alberto Ríos had massive **gambling debts**.
- Testimony from a fired employee who claimed to have seen **Ríos removing boxes** from the factory days before the fire.
- Residue of the potassium-based accelerant found in a fire-protected corner, identified via **gas chromatography**.

Forensic Analysis: The laboratory confirmed that the accelerant was a **specialized mixture used in the metallurgical industry**, a sector in which Ríos had worked before opening the textile factory. This connected the suspect to the specific means used in the crime.

Resolution: Confronted with the forensic and financial evidence, **Alberto Ríos confessed** to starting the fire to collect the insurance. He was convicted of **fraud and arson**.